language that Gen Z understands, and on a device near you. Spirituality is now something you can comfortably binge-watch late into the night, without the need to respect guru-shishya boundaries or hard labour towards enlightenment. Social media is teeming with reels, shorts and posts by spiritual gurus and influencers who are couching spirituality in terms Gen Z wants to hear—'self-love', 'self-care', 'vibes' and 'being one with the universe'—to deal with their angst. You don't even have to place these gurus on a pedestal; they can be your brother, sister or friend.

Sadhguru Jaggi Vasudev, founder and head of Isha Foundation, recounts how recently three 10-year-old boys came up to him in Bengaluru and told him, "We watch you on YouTube. All our friends watch your videos."

And social media has become a whole new window to the universe of spirituality, for the giver and receiver alike. "You can reach the whole world from one location," says Sadhguru. "Whether it was Adiyogi himself, Gautam Buddha, Krishna or Jesus… no one had this opportunity." For those in need of a dose of spirituality, there is some-thing for everyone on the vast terrain that is social media. "With life becoming stressful, people are looking for true rest and happiness," says Sri Sri Ravi Shankar, spiritual guru and founder, Art of Living. "Spirituality is the most pragmatic tool to cope." And social media is where you can find it easily.

But the very boon of social media can soon turn into a bane. For one, spiritual influencers have to innovate constantly to garner more followers, hold their interest and to stand out from the crowd. "To be interesting, you need to cater to a fast-paced world," says



"Social media opened up so many doors for me. In **early 2020, I quit my** profession as an architect and now teach yoga around the world"

-SHANI DAYAL, *Wellness Coach*